

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Obeying to Get a Blessing

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/32582-obeying-to-get-a-blessing

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Obeying to Get a Blessing

Why did the Israelites repeatedly worship other gods, even after experiencing God's dramatic deliverance from Egypt through plagues, the parting of the Red Sea, and food falling from heaven in the desert? Perhaps they wanted more control.

The appeal of an idol is its simplicity. If you follow the rules, you can expect to get certain benefits. It was easy for the Israelites to believe that the most expedient way to get what they wanted was to pay their dues to the idol. Toss in a little sensuality, greed, and fear, and their worship of false gods becomes more understandable.

 Obey for blessing

The results from following God, however, are profoundly out of our control. God promises blessings to those who follow Him—blessings in this life and blessings for all of eternity. The huge difference though is that trusting God to know when and how to bless us takes us out of control. We can no longer think of God as our all-powerful vending machine—we put in two coins of obedience and a few pennies of church attendance and *presto* we get the blessing of our choice.

Trust involves submitting to the eternal wisdom of God—the same God who allowed some to become martyrs and some influential rulers.

Trusting God to provide for us, whether for moment-by-moment needs, life direction, safety, comfort, or joy, requires humility. Some people might obey in order to make a deal with God. When they receive something good in their lives, they assume they are getting what was rightfully due to them. It was earned through their obedience. Others, however, might obey God motivated by love and trust. As a result, they receive God's good gifts like a child finding an especially beautiful flower—with joyful surprise and genuine thankfulness.

As with any aspect of this discussion of obedience, the goal is to stay focused and responsive to the person we are following. Our relationship with Jesus is the priority. Anytime we focus on something other than intimacy, whether it is to get blessings, to avoid trouble, or just to follow the rules, we lose the point of obedience: obedience is one way we follow, trust, and worship Jesus.

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → jesusonline.com/review

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesusonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesusonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesusonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesusonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping